

Who Is This Book For?

This book is intended for people who already have some familiarity with Python and with using basic functions from the Python Standard Library. I will assume that you understand the fundamental syntax of the language and can write small- to medium-sized programs using variables, assignment statements, `if/elif/else` statements, `while` and `for` loops, functions and function calls, lists, dictionaries, and so on. If you aren't comfortable with all of these concepts, then I suggest that you get a copy of my earlier book, *Learn to Program with Python 3* (Apress), and read that first.

This is an intermediate-level text, so there are a number of more advanced topics that I will not address. For example, to keep the book practical, I will not often go into detail on the internal implementation of Python. For simplicity and clarity, and to keep the focus on mastering OOP techniques, the examples are written using a limited subset of the language. There are more advanced and concise ways to code in Python that are beyond the scope of this book.

I will cover the underlying details of OOP in a mostly language-independent way, but will point out areas where there are differences between Python and other OOP languages. Having learned the basics of OOP-style coding through this book, if you wish, you should be able to easily apply these techniques to other OOP languages.

Python Version(s) and Installation

All the example code in this book was written and tested using Python versions 3.6 through 3.9. All the examples should work fine with version 3.6 or newer.

Python is available for free at <https://www.python.org>. If you don't have Python installed, or you want to upgrade to the latest version, go to that site, find the Downloads tab, and click the **Download** button. This will download an installable file onto your computer. Double-click the file that was downloaded to install Python.